

## PROJECT DELIVERABLE: ENVISIONED AND RATIONALIZED MVP

**Project Name:** BookExchange

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### 1. THE ENVISIONED MVP (PROJECT SCOPE)

The envisioned Minimum Viable Product (MVP) for BookExchange is a web application designed to enable University students to buy and sell used textbooks directly to one another. The scope is focused on a "Simple 4-Step Process" to reduce textbook costs and promote reuse on campus.

#### Core Features Included in the MVP:

- **Post Listing Feature:** Allows sellers to list textbooks with title, course code, condition, and price.
- **Browse and Search:** A central interface to find books by course code, title, or department.
- **Detailed Listing View:** A page displaying full listing information and seller contact details.
- **Listing Management:** Functionality for sellers to edit, delete, or mark listings as "sold".
- **Data Persistence:** Use of browser-based LocalStorage for data storage to adhere to a \$0 budget.

### 2. RATIONALIZATION OF THE MVP

The features selected for this MVP have been rationalized based on the specific project constraints and goals defined in the project charter and business case:

- **Financial Rationalization:** With a project budget of \$0, we are rationalizing the use of free tools and LocalStorage instead of a paid backend server.
- **Technical Rationalization:** As this is the team's first project, we are prioritizing core HTML, CSS, and JavaScript functionality to ensure delivery by the project deadline.
- **Economic Rationalization:** The MVP directly addresses the \$1,200+ average yearly textbook cost by allowing buyers to save 30-70% compared to full bookstore prices.
- **Community Rationalization:** By focusing on the University of Regina campus, we leverage existing trust for safe, in-person exchanges, removing the need for a middle-man payment processor.

### 3. RATIONALIZATION OF EXCLUSIONS (OUT OF SCOPE)

To protect the project timeline and maintain the \$0 budget, the following features are rationalized as **Out of Scope** for the initial MVP:

- **User Accounts and Login:** Excluded to avoid the development complexity and security risks associated with backend authentication.
- **In-App Messaging:** Rationalized as unnecessary for the MVP, as direct contact via email or phone is sufficient for campus-based exchanges.
- **Payment Processing:** Excluded because transactions are intended to be peer-to-peer cash or e-transfer exchanges performed on campus.
- **Push Notifications and Ratings:** Deferred to future versions to maintain a lean development cycle.